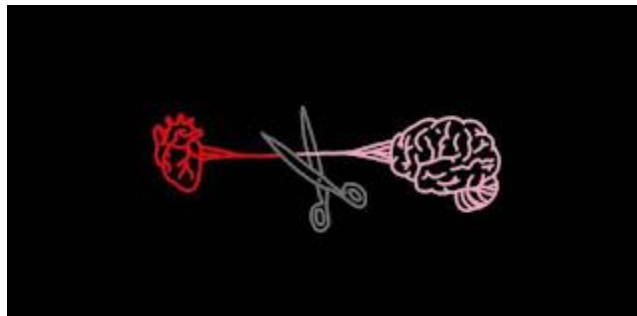


The Dark History of Neurosurgery: When Asylums Became Slaughterhouses

By: The Future Neurosurgeon 'Isra Bouchentouf' – May 2026

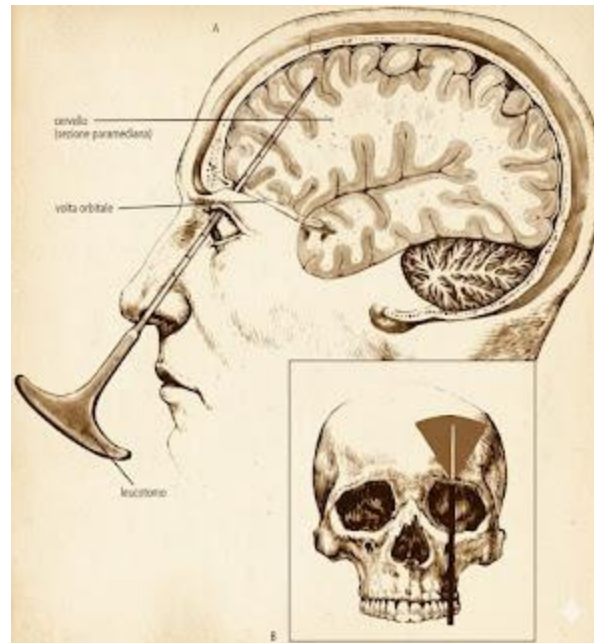


In the 1930s, psychiatric asylums were far from being humane sanctuaries for the sick. Instead, they were places of pure terror, where patients were routinely abused and used as lab rats. Society back then looked at mentally ill individuals as outcasts who did not deserve a dignified life. In the middle of this dark era, a horrific medical experiment was born.

A Nobel Prize for a Fatal Idea

A Portuguese neurologist named **António Egas Moniz** was searching for a way to cure mental illness by disconnecting the frontal lobe from the rest of the brain. He tested his theory on chimpanzees, and because the primates became calmer, he believed he succeeded. In 1935, Moniz introduced his procedure to the world. Despite the devastating reality of this surgery, Moniz was shockingly awarded the **Nobel Prize in Medicine in 1949**.

The Ice-Pick and the Hammer: Walter Freeman's Evil Trade



Shortly after, an American physician named **Walter Freeman** took the idea and turned it into a quick, gruesome assembly line. He invented the "Ice-Pick Lobotomy"—a procedure where a sharp steel instrument was driven through the patient's eye socket using a hammer, swinging it to destroy the frontal lobe connections.

Patients had no say in the matter. Because mental illness was seen as a family shame, relatives forced patients into surgery without their consent. For surgeons like Freeman, the driving forces were money and fame, not human empathy.

The Voices of the Silent Victims



Among the countless lives destroyed by this medical atrocity, two names remain unforgettable:

- **Rosemary Kennedy:** The sister of the US President John F. Kennedy. She went into surgery as a vibrant, moody young woman and came out permanently incapacitated, unable to speak or walk properly for the rest of her life.
- **Howard Dully:** He was subjected to a lobotomy at the tender age of 12, forced into it by his stepmother. Though he suffered immensely, Dully survived to tell his tale, writing a famous book about his painful journey.

A Permanent Stain on Science

Eventually, after turning thousands of human beings into silent ghosts, the lobotomy was banned worldwide. Yet, to this day, Moniz's Nobel Prize has never been revoked. It remains a historic stain on the scientific world—a monument to the innocent souls who were sacrificed for the pride and greed of men.